Therapeutic Communication

Mental Health | Foundations and Therapeutic Communication

REMEMBER IT AS

Feelings first, no 'why'

- **Focus on feelings**
  Reflect and clarify what the client is experiencing.
- **Avoid 'why' questions**
  They sound judgmental and make clients defensive.
- **Avoid false reassurance**
  'Everything will be fine' shuts the conversation down.

NURSE TIP

On the exam, pick the answer that keeps the client talking about their feelings.